CLASS 10 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 16: **Political Parties (Political Science)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Assertion (A): Over-regulation of political parties can be counter-productive. Reason (R): Parties may then find ways to cheat the law. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

2. Assertion (A): The Bahujan Samaj Party seeks to secure power for the bahujan samaj. Reason (R): It was founded in 1984 under Kanshi Ram. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

3. Assertion (A): The anti-defection law has completely strengthened internal party democracy. Reason (R): The law makes any dissent more difficult. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

4. Match: 1 Congress; 2 BJP; 3 CPI-M; 4 Telugu Desam with A NDA; B State party; C UPA; D Left Front. Correct: 1

(a) 1-C, 2-D, 3-A, 4-B
(b) 1-A, 2-C, 3-B, 4-D
(c) 1-C, 2-A, 3-D, 4-B
(d) 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

5. Assertion (A): Political parties are necessary for representative democracy. Reason (R): Without parties every candidate would be independent and no one would be responsible for how the country is run. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

6. Assertion (A): Parties lack internal democracy. Reason (R): Parties do not keep membership registers or hold regular organisational elections. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

7. A party has units in several States, all following the policies and programmes decided at the national level. It is most likely a: 1

(a) independent candidate
(b) national party
(c) State party
(d) pressure group

8. When people say a party suffers 'lack of meaningful choice', what is a proper test? 1

(a) Whether they contest every seat
(b) Whether they have members
(c) Whether they have symbols
(d) Whether parties' policies differ significantly

9. **Assertion (A):** Political parties are an essential part of a democracy. 1
Reason (R): Parties contest elections, form governments, make policies and act as the opposition when not in power.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** The Indian National Congress was founded in 1885. 1
Reason (R): The Bharatiya Janata Party was founded in 1980.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why are party lists of candidates chosen by top leaders a concern? 2

12. Why are recognised parties given symbols? 2

13. Why does the chapter say party systems cannot be chosen? 2

14. How are pressure groups related to parties? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Assess the statement: 'Parties are a necessary condition for democracy.' 3

16. Discuss how the rise of State parties changed Indian politics. 3

17. Examine how the media and movements can reform parties. 3

OR

Why are the sources of money for parties a concern? 3

18. Argue whether over-regulation or citizen participation is the better route to party reform. 3

OR

How does the use of affidavits help voters yet remain limited? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** In a state, a party wins 90 of 200 seats in an assembly election and cannot form the government by itself. Several smaller parties then join it, and together they cross the halfway mark to form a government. The remaining parties sit on the opposite benches and criticise the government's policies. 5
(i) What is the term for such a government formed by several parties together?
(ii) How many seats are needed for a majority in a 200-seat assembly?
(iii) What role do the parties on the opposite benches play?
(iv) Why is a strong opposition useful in a democracy?

20. Write an essay on how citizens can reform political parties. 5

OR

Evaluate how the multiparty system and coalition governments have affected India's democracy. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks